

DG penetration and recloser-fuse coordination

Replication of Fig. 7 of Yousaf et al. (2022) in DIgSILENT PowerFactory, IEEE 13-node feeder — results, how they match the paper, and prepared answers to the panel's questions

1. The claim in one paragraph

When a synchronous DG is added downstream of the recloser, the fault current through a lateral fuse rises (grid share + DG share) while the current through the recloser stays the same or falls (grid share only). The fuse therefore melts faster, the recloser does not trip faster, and the coordination time interval $CTI = t_{MMT}(\text{fuse}) - t_{fast}(\text{recloser})$ **decreases** with penetration until the fuse melts first and fuse saving is lost. This is what Fig. 7 of the paper shows, and the seven PowerFactory models reproduce it: at node 633 the fuse current rises from 4102 A to 5426 A (+32 %) while R1's current falls from 4162 A to 3970 A (−5 %), and the CTI falls from +4 ms to -51 ms.

2. What was modelled

Item	In this study
Models	Seven separate PowerFactory projects (and .pfd files), copies of the replication model; the original is unchanged
Penetration	DG rating / 4.05 MVA (the paper's DG): 0, 10, 25, 37, 50, 75, 100 %. Machine, its 0.69/4.16 kV transformer and its P, Q are scaled together; per-unit impedances (Table I) unchanged; 0 % = DG out
Protection	The conventional (preset) scheme, unchanged at every level: R1 IAC77B801A 720 A TDS 0.5/10; R2 CDG34 300/600 A TMS 0.1/1.0, no reverse group; fuses of the design without DG
Times	PowerFactory's own relay and fuse elements (c:Ttrip); fuse time = minimum melting
Node 633 (internal, R1's zone)	Three-phase bolted fault at 633; fuse F633 (250E) against R1 fast
Node 671 (external, R2's zone)	Line-to-line fault at 684, on the lateral that leaves 671 through fuse F671-2 (300E), against R2 fast
Percentages	As in the paper's doughnut chart each ring adds up to 100 %: $CTI \% = 100 \times CTI / \sum CTI $ (sign kept)

3. Results against the paper

Fig. 7 - percentage variation of the CTI with DG penetration (each ring = 100 %; negative = fuse melts before the recloser's fast trip)

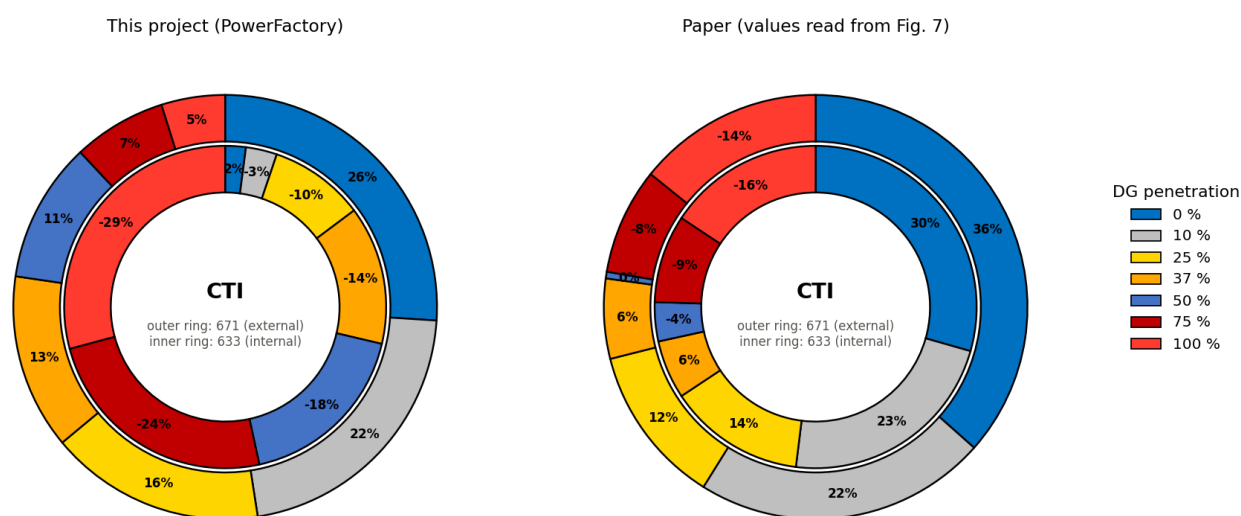
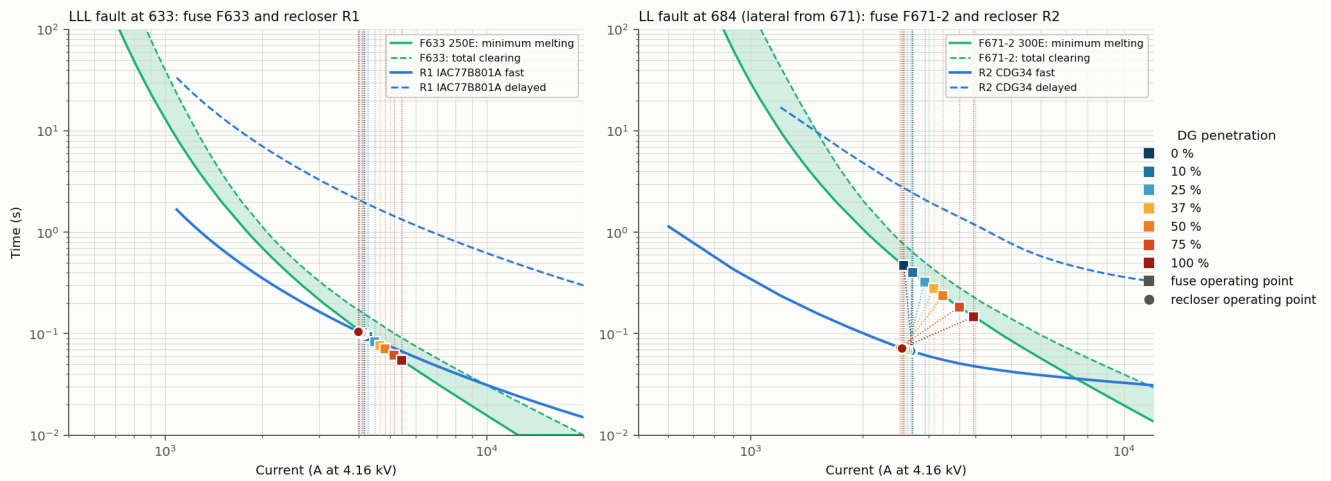


Fig. 7 replicated (left) beside the paper's values (right). Outer ring 671, inner ring 633.

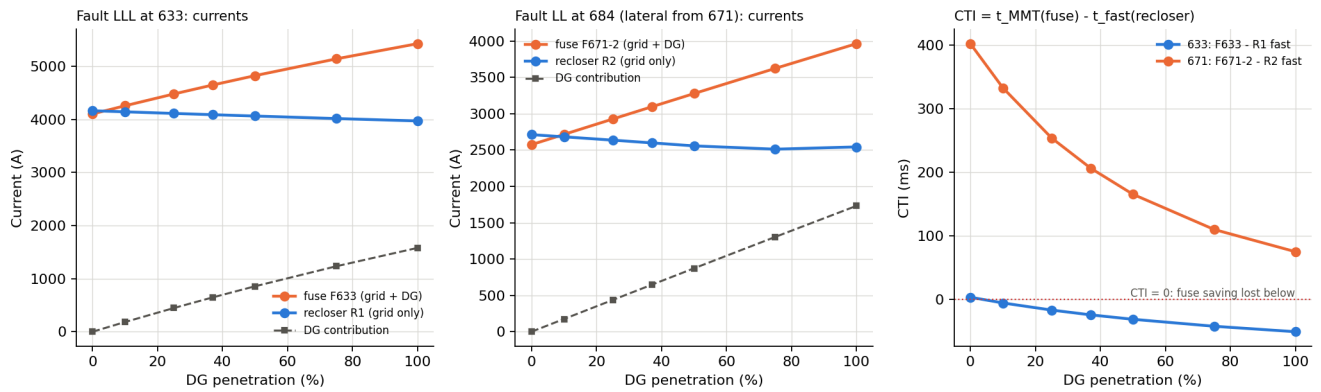
DG	633: fuse / R1 (A)	633 CTI	633 %: ours / paper	671: fuse / R2 (A)	671 CTI	671 %: ours / paper
0 %	4102 / 4162	+4 ms	+2.1 / +30	2574 / 2711	+403 ms	+26.0 / +36
10 %	4256 / 4142	-5 ms	-3.1 / +23	2715 / 2681	+333 ms	+21.5 / +22
25 %	4478 / 4111	-17 ms	-9.6 / +14	2926 / 2636	+254 ms	+16.4 / +12
37 %	4648 / 4088	-24 ms	-13.9 / +6	3094 / 2598	+207 ms	+13.4 / +6
50 %	4824 / 4062	-31 ms	-17.9 / -4	3276 / 2557	+166 ms	+10.7 / +0
75 %	5140 / 4015	-42 ms	-24.2 / -9	3623 / 2511	+110 ms	+7.1 / -8
100 %	5426 / 3970	-51 ms	-29.2 / -16	3963 / 2543	+75 ms	+4.9 / -14

What agrees: the direction of the effect — at both nodes the CTI falls monotonically as penetration rises; at 671 the shares of the first four levels are close to the paper's (26 / 22 / 16 / 13 %% against 36 / 22 / 12 / 6 %%). **What differs:** where the CTI crosses zero. 633 starts with only 4 ms of margin and is negative from about 4 %%; 671 starts with 403 ms and stays positive (75 ms at 100 %%). The paper crosses zero at about 40-50 %% at both nodes. The reasons are in Q4 and Q5.

TCC with increasing DG penetration (conventional settings): the recloser point stays, the fuse point moves right and down



TCC of both cases with all levels: the curves are fixed (settings unchanged); the recloser's operating point (circle) stays where it is, the fuse's point (square) moves to higher current and shorter time.



Currents through the fuse (grid + DG), the recloser (grid only) and from the DG, and the resulting CTI.

4. Questions the panel may ask, with answers

Q1. With DG the short-circuit contribution from the source decreases, so the recloser and the fuse should both see less current and the CTI should increase. Why do you get a decreasing CTI?

The first half is correct and the model shows it: the **source (grid) contribution falls** — R1 carries 4162 A at 0 % and 3970 A at 100 %, because the DG holds up the voltage at the common part of the network during the fault (infeed effect). If the fuse also carried only the grid share, the CTI would indeed **increase** slightly: last column of the table, +0.2 ms to +4.7 ms.

But the fuse is **between the fault and both sources**. It carries the grid share and the DG share together, so its current **rises** (4102 → 5426 A) while the recloser's falls. The total fault level at 633 rises from 4102 A to 5426 A (+32 %). A fuse curve is steep, so the extra current shortens its melting time much more than the slightly lower current lengthens R1's time: F633 melts at 0.055 s instead of 0.102 s, R1 trips at 0.106 s instead of 0.098 s. The CTI is the difference of the two, so it decreases.

DG	Total at fault 633 (A)	Grid share = R1 (A)	DG share (A)	Fuse F633 (A)	R1 fast (s)	F633 melts (s)	CTI (ms)	CTI if the fuse saw only the grid share (ms)
0 %	4102	4162	0	4102	0.098	0.102	+4	+0.2
10 %	4256	4142	183	4256	0.099	0.094	-5	+0.6
25 %	4478	4111	446	4478	0.100	0.083	-17	+1.3
37 %	4648	4088	647	4648	0.101	0.077	-24	+1.8
50 %	4824	4062	856	4824	0.102	0.071	-31	+2.4
75 %	5140	4015	1233	5140	0.104	0.062	-42	+3.5
100 %	5426	3970	1580	5426	0.106	0.055	-51	+4.7

The fuse current is the phasor sum of the two shares, so it is slightly less than the arithmetic sum. This is exactly the mechanism the paper states (Section II): the DG's contribution flows through the fuse but not through the upstream recloser.

Q2. How did you define the penetration level, and why that way?

As the DG rating relative to the paper's DG of 4.05 MVA, which equals the total feeder load of the IEEE 13-node feeder. The paper gives the levels but not its formula; this definition makes 100 % the case of the paper's main study, so the 100 % model reproduces the replication exactly (same currents and times). The machine, its step-up transformer and its power output are scaled together, so the per-unit impedances of Table I stay as published and the DG's fault contribution scales with its size (183 A at 10 %, 1580 A at 100 % for the fault at 633).

Q3. Why are the relay settings and fuse sizes kept the same at every level?

Because that is what Fig. 7 tests: how a scheme designed without DG degrades when DG is added. Changing the settings with each level would hide the effect. Adapting the settings is the paper's proposal (the DSDR), and its result is shown separately in the replication (Q12).

Q4. Why does node 633 become negative already at about 4 % penetration, while the paper reaches zero at 40-50 %?

Because the margin without DG is already very small in this model: F633 (250E) melts in 0.102 s and R1 trips in 0.098 s, only 4 ms apart. Any extra current through the fuse removes that margin. The paper's starting margin is about 30 % of the ring, so it needs much more DG to cross zero. The paper does not publish the fuse sizes and settings behind Fig. 7; a larger fuse at 633 (e.g. the 400E chosen by the method's fuse revision) would move the crossing to a higher penetration. The trend is the same; the crossing point depends on the starting margin.

Q5. Why does node 671 never become negative?

F671-2 (300E) starts with a large margin: 0.470 s against R2's 0.067 s (CTI +403 ms). The DG raises the fuse current from 2574 A to 3963 A and the CTI falls by 81 % to +75 ms, but 100 % penetration is not enough to close the gap. With the paper's higher fault levels the fuse would sit further down its curve and reach zero earlier. The shares of the first levels (26 / 22 / 16 / 13 %) are close to the paper's (36 / 22 / 12 / 6 %).

Q6. What do the percentages in Fig. 7 mean? Is that a percentage of the CTI?

The paper's Fig. 7 is a doughnut chart: the seven segments of each ring add up to 100 %, so each value is that level's share of the ring. It is computed here as $CTI \% = 100 \times CTI / \sum |CTI|$ with the sign kept, which gives 100 % per ring (the paper's rings add up to 102 % and 98 % as read from the figure). The CTI in seconds is given beside it, because the share alone does not show the absolute margin.

Q7. Why is the 671 case a fault at 684 and not at node 671 itself?

A fault on bus 671 is not downstream of any fuse, so there is no fuse–recloser pair to coordinate. The fuse located at 671 whose current includes the DG share is F671-2, at the start of the 671–684 lateral. PowerFactory does not accept a fault inside that two-phase line, so the fault is at its end, node 684 (the lateral is 300 ft long). The fault is line-to-line because the lateral has only phases a and c.

Q8. How does the short-circuit level change with penetration, and where most?

It rises at every node, most near the DG at 692 (671, 675: about +60 %) and least behind the 4.16/0.48 kV transformer (634: +12 %) and on the single-phase laterals (611, 652: about +20 %). Largest bolted fault at each node, A:

Node	0 %	25 %	50 %	75 %	100 %	Change
632	4735	5227	5690	6123	6526	+38 %
633	4102	4478	4824	5140	5426	+32 %
645	3418	3685	3932	4149	4341	+27 %
646	3112	3332	3528	3701	3854	+24 %
DL	3946	4454	4952	5436	5902	+50 %
671	3390	3919	4461	5010	5564	+64 %
675	3151	3612	4087	4557	5022	+59 %
680	2930	3322	3711	4091	4460	+52 %
684	2655	3027	3395	3756	4107	+55 %
652	1874	1983	2080	2164	2239	+19 %
611	1857	1973	2074	2161	2236	+20 %

At the same time the current through the reclosers stays the same or falls (R1 –0 to –21 %), so a larger fault does not mean a faster recloser — only a faster fuse.

Q9. What does R2 do for the fault at 633, which is outside its zone?

With DG it carries the DG's current towards the fault, in the reverse direction (66 A at 0 % rising to 1500 A at 100 %). The conventional R2 is not directional, so from about 37 % this reverse current is large enough to start its fast curve, and its time falls to 0.160 s at 100 %. In these bolted cases F633 still melts first, but R2 is now racing the fuse for a fault outside its zone: with a slower fuse (for example the 400E that the fuse revision needs) or a fault through impedance, R2 trips first and disconnects the healthy part of the feeder beyond 671 together with the DG — a nuisance trip. Preventing this is the purpose of the paper's directional dual setting.

DG	R2 current, fault at 633 (A)	R2 direction	Conventional R2 fast trip (s)	F633 melts (s)
0 %	66	-	does not trip	0.102
10 %	161	reverse	does not trip	0.094
25 %	416	reverse	does not trip	0.083
37 %	610	reverse	1.109	0.077

DG	R2 current, fault at 633 (A)	R2 direction	Conventional R2 fast trip (s)	F633 melts (s)
50 %	811	reverse	0.551	0.071
75 %	1171	reverse	0.250	0.062
100 %	1500	reverse	0.160	0.055

Q10. Should the pickup currents change with penetration?

By eq. (3) of the paper, yes: the DG supplies part of the load locally, so the load current through the reclosers falls and $1.25 \times I_{nom}$ falls with it (R1 734.6 $\rightarrow$ 356.1 A). R2's load flow reverses between 75 and 100 %, so a reverse pickup (eq. 12, 315 A) becomes necessary only at 100 %. With the fixed pickups the reclosers lose sensitivity: R2's fast curve (starting at 600 A) no longer sees the lowest 3 Ω fault in its zone above 50 %; R1 is marginal already without DG.

DG	R1 $1.25 \times I_{nom}$ (A)	R1 lowest 3 Ω fault (A)	R2 load flow	R2 $1.25 \times I_{nom}$ (A)	R2 lowest 3 Ω fault (A)
0 %	734.6	1074 (missed)	forward	587.5	878
10 %	678.9	1018 (missed)	forward	537.6	821
25 %	600.9	937 (missed)	forward	465.2	738
37 %	543.5	874 (missed)	forward	410.8	673
50 %	487.4	809 (missed)	forward	356.6	606
75 %	401.5	689 (missed)	forward	278.0	483 (missed)
100 %	356.1	577 (missed)	reverse	315.2	368 (missed)

Settings set in the models: R1 720 A (curve from 1080 A), R2 300 / 600 A (fast curve from 600 A).

Q11. How reliable are these numbers?

The feeder reproduces the paper's rated branch currents within 2 % and the IEEE short-circuit benchmark within about 2 %. The 100 % model gives exactly the currents and times of the replication. All operating times in this study are PowerFactory's own relay and fuse calculations; the curves used for the plots agree with them within 1.2 % over 1896 operating times. The remaining differences to the paper come from data the paper does not publish: fuse sizes, R2's settings, the source impedance and the exact fault behind each point of Fig. 7.

Q12. Does this support the paper's conclusion?

Yes, qualitatively and in mechanism: (1) the preset coordination degrades monotonically with DG penetration; (2) it is lost above a threshold; (3) the cause is the DG current that passes the fuse but not the recloser; (4) the mid-line recloser additionally sees reverse current and, without direction, trips for faults outside its zone. In the replication, making R2 a dual-setting directional recloser and revising the fuses restores coordination in 38 of 39 fault cells at 100 % penetration, against 24 with the conventional scheme (31 with the revised fuses alone). The threshold itself depends on the starting margin, which the paper does not give, so it is not reproduced exactly.

Q13. What about other fault types?

The same trend holds. LL at 633: CTI +29 ms at 0 % and -52 ms at 100 %. LG at 684: +851 ms and +402 ms. Every fault type that passes the DG current through the fuse but not through the recloser shrinks the margin.

5. Limitations to state openly

- The fuse and fault behind each node of Fig. 7 are not given in the paper; the pairs used here are the natural ones (the fuse at the node whose current includes the DG share).
- Bolted faults; a fault impedance lowers all currents and shifts every point to the left on the TCC.
- One DG location (692), as in the paper; the paper notes a similar effect for other locations.
- Coordination judged on the start of melting with zero margin; a breaker time or a fuse margin makes the loss appear earlier.